

Q1. “Seeking Engineering knowledge is an Ibadah” — Explain it in the light of the Qur’an, Hadith, and Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.’s saying

In Islam, **seeking beneficial knowledge**, including engineering knowledge, is considered **Ibadah** when it is done with sincerity and correct intention. Islam teaches that worship is not limited to prayer or fasting; rather, it includes all actions done to please Allah.

Allah clearly states the purpose of creation:

وَمَا خَلَقْتُ الْجِنَّ وَالْإِنْسَ إِلَّا لِيَعْبُدُونِ

“And I did not create the jinn and mankind except to worship Me.”
(Qur’an 51:56)

Engineering knowledge helps society by improving infrastructure, safety, healthcare, and technology. When a Muslim studies engineering to serve humanity, earn halal income, and fulfill responsibilities honestly, it becomes worship. The Prophet ﷺ said:

طَلَبُ الْعِلْمِ فَرِيضَةٌ عَلَى كُلِّ مُسْلِمٍ

“Seeking knowledge is obligatory upon every Muslim.”
(Ibn Majah)

Islam emphasizes **intention (niyyah)**. The Prophet ﷺ said:

إِنَّمَا الْأَعْمَالُ بِالنِّيَّاتِ

“Actions are judged by intentions.”
(Bukhari)

Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. said:

“Intelligence plus character — that is the goal of true education.”

This statement aligns perfectly with Islamic teachings. Islam values knowledge that is guided by **character, ethics, and responsibility**. An engineer with knowledge but no morality may cause harm, while one with faith and character benefits society.

Therefore, seeking engineering knowledge becomes **Ibadah** when it is pursued sincerely, ethically, and for the pleasure of Allah, as emphasized in the course.

Q2. Define Ibadah with reference from the Qur'an and explain "Working is Ibadah".

The word **Ibadah** (عبادة) in Arabic means obedience, submission, humility, and love. In Islam, Ibadah refers to **complete submission to Allah with ultimate love and sincerity**.

Allah says:

وَمَا خَلَقْتُ الْجِنَّ وَالْإِنْسَ إِلَّا لِيَعْبُدُونِ

"And I did not create the jinn and mankind except to worship Me."
(Qur'an 51:56)

Ibn Taymiyyah defined Ibadah as everything Allah loves and accepts, including actions of the heart and body. This includes prayer, charity, honesty, helping others, and earning halal income.

Working is considered Ibadah when certain conditions are met:

1. The work must be halal
2. The intention must be sincere
3. The work must be done with excellence
4. It must not lead to disobedience of Allah

The Prophet ﷺ said:

“No one eats better food than that which he earns with his own hands.”

(Bukhari)

Islam does not encourage laziness or isolation from life. Rather, it teaches Muslims to work responsibly and honestly. When a person works to support family, help society, and remain independent, that work becomes worship.

Thus, Islam presents a **comprehensive concept of Ibadah**, where both religious and worldly activities are connected to Allah through intention and obedience.

Q3. Why do we worship Allah although worship does not benefit Him?

Allah is **completely independent** and does not need human worship.

Worship does not increase His power or greatness. Allah says:

إِنْ تَكْفُرُوا فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ غَنِيٌّ عَنْكُمْ

“If you disbelieve, indeed Allah is Free from need of you.”

(Qur'an 39:7)

So why do we worship Allah? The answer is that **worship benefits us**, not Allah. Worship purifies the soul, builds discipline, and gives purpose to life.

Allah says:

قَدْ أَفْلَحَ مَنْ زَكَّاهَا

“He who purifies his soul is successful.”

(Qur'an 91:9)

Worship helps humans recognize their dependence on Allah and keeps them away from arrogance and corruption. It brings inner peace and moral strength. The Qur'an says:

إِنَّ الصَّلَاةَ تَنْهَى عَنِ الْفَحْشَاءِ وَالْمُنْكَرِ

“Indeed, prayer prevents immorality and wrongdoing.”

(Qur'an 29:45)

Islam teaches that the goal of life is not only worldly success but eternal success in the Hereafter. Worship prepares a believer for accountability and the meeting with Allah.

The Prophet ﷺ worshipped Allah extensively, not out of need, but out of love and gratitude. Worship also brings Allah's mercy and guidance.

Therefore, we worship Allah because **He deserves worship**, and because it leads to our purification, success, and fulfillment of the true purpose of life.